> the shore, and the cargoes have to be conveyed in boats, either for loading or discharging. At the moment that I am writing these pages, the name of the king of this place is Caelobothras [Keralaputra]. Another port, and a much more convenient one, is that which lies in the territory of the people called Neacyndi, *Barace* by name. Here king Pandion [Pandya] used to reign, dwelling at a considerable distance from the market in the interior, at a city known as *Modiera* [Madurai].

So extensive was the India trade at this time that it had begun to threaten Rome's gold and silver reserves, with Pliny complaining that India, Arabia and China were together taking a hundred million sesterces from Rome every year, the bulk of it ending in South India. This is confirmed by the remarkable number of hoards of Roman coins reported in Kerala from the nineteenth century onwards. One such hoard of gold and silver coins, said to amount to 'five coolie loads', was reported near Cannanore (Kannur) in 1847. Most of the coins quickly disappeared but fifty-one were saved for the Madras Museum: ten from the reign of Emperor Augustus, four from Tiberius, four from Caligula, fifteen from Claudius, thirteen from Nero and five from Antonius Pius. In 1945 another major Roman hoard was found in an earthen pot near one of St Thomas's seven churches at Palayoor, including twelve gold and seventy-one silver coins and covering a period from the first century BCE up to Trajan in 117 CE. A third major hoard of reportedly two thousand coins came to light in 1983 in Parur, the site of another of St Thomas's churches, near Cranganore (Kodungallur), sited beside the mouth of the present course of the Periyar River, just a few miles north of Cochin. This, too, was rapidly dispersed but some two hundred and fifty coins were saved for the local museum.

It was this last discovery that renewed interest in establishing the exact location of ancient Muziris/Muciri and